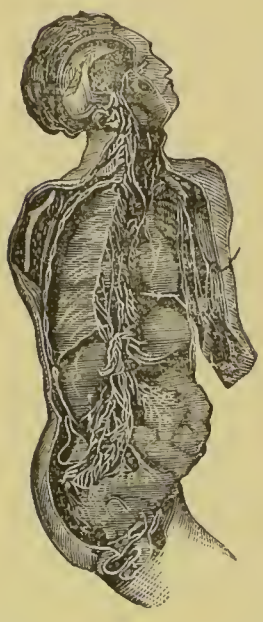
SYMPATHETIC NERVE.

According to Dalton's Human Physiology, the sympathetic nerve is distributed to organs over which the consciousness and will have no immediate control. It serves as a medium of reflex action between the sensitive and motor part of the digestive, excretory, and generative apparatuses; and it is certain that it also takes part in the reflex actions in which the cerebro-spinal system is at the same time interested. There are, accordingly, three different kinds of reflex action taking place wholly or partially through the sympathetic system, which may be observed in the living body.

FIG. 5—No. 1.



1. Reflex actions taking place from the internal organs through the sympathetic and cerebro-spinal systems, to the voluntary muscles and sensitive surfaces. The convulsions of young children are often owing to irritation of indigested food in the intestinal canal. Attacks of indigestion are also known to produce temporary amaurosis, double lesion, strabismus, and even hemiplegia. Nausea and a diminished or capricious appetite are often prominent symptoms of early pregnancy, induced by the peculiar condition of the uterine mucous membrane.